

Mary Tallontire

Creative Technology

Indie Game Development

Immersive Experiences

Virtual Worlds

Interactive Digital Art

Responsible Technology

Blender

Unity

AR and VR

I am a digital worldbuilder, creative technologist and artist from Leeds, UK, creating digital games, installations and immersive artworks with a socially engaged practice. My work is largely inspired by glitch art, solar punk, worlding, and video games, featuring forests, plants and environmental themes in a variety of contexts across time and space: worlds current, speculative and historic, frequently juxtaposing natural elements with the digital realm. I'm interested in the potential of digital experiences to educate and create explorative, playful and social spaces, particularly in environmental contexts, whilst leaning into game art and glitch aesthetics.

Education

2024/25- MSc Digital Media and Design, University of Edinburgh (distinction)

2020/23- BSc Digital Arts Computing, Goldsmiths University (first)

2024- Beyond Brontes, Screen Yorkshire

CV

2026:

(upcoming) - Giving talk about my game Hedgeborough at Untitled Games Event, Amsterdam

- Hotel Generation 2026 finalist at arebyte Digital Art Centre, London
- Screening of The Garden at Hyde Park Picture House as part of Situation Leeds festival
- Game Hedgeborough featured at Voidspace Live 2026
- Three video works featured in arebyte Digital Art Centre's BYOB screening event
- Game 'Breadleg' selected for Kaboom Animation Festival 2026
- Zine 'This wasn't where you were meant to go' featured in the digital zine library at exhibition 'Connection Established: Digital Folklore and Web Craft' at The Photographers' Gallery.
- 3D artist for Cold Star Media working in Blender and Unity to create a sci-fi scene for immersive music videos (contract)



2025:

- Commissioned by Waterside Arts to create The Garden for Prism Festival 2025
- Games Breadleg and Rarity selected for Playtopia Festival 2025
- Game 'Vegs Slop' featured at Voidspace Live 2025
- 2025- Honourable mention in Zero Day Productions: Solar Punk Jam as part of duo Gertrude Bungalow
- 2025- Guest exhibitor at ECGX and MDes Game Design, Herriot-Watt showcase

2024:

- Creative Technologist (various contracts), Reflex Arc
- Game Rarity featured at Voidspace Live 2024
- Game Rarity featured in alternative indie games magazine Indiepocalypse #53 and Voidspace #9

2023:

- Design Intern, Potion Pictures and freelance work for Potion Pictures
- Artist in Residence, Thin Air at The Beams

2022:

- Exhibited piece No One's Land at With Whom We Mutually Communicate? at Copeland Gallery

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The Garden

Interactive Digital Art

Immersive Experience

Virtual World

Solar Punk

Unity

Blender

NodeJS

Interactive, immersive experience originally commissioned by Waterside Arts for Prism Festival 2025. Installation inspired by solar punk, science fiction and optimistic visions of a sustainable future, this everchanging digital world is projected on 4 walls of a space to create a 360 view into a new realm with a surround sound procedural soundscape. Created using the Unity, the speculative world reacts to the collective decisions of audience members, who interact through a web browser on their phones, allowing visitors to collectively influence the virtual weather. This causes solar energy or rainwater to accumulate, which is used to power lights, sprinklers and other objects within the digital space, creating continuous change within the environment. Engaging for multiple generations, the audience interacts with the digital world and with each other, inspiring social interactions between audience members.

Encourages people to explore new worlds and imagining hopeful futures, immersing the audience into a place of optimism away from climate anxiety. It is a solar punk experience: an anti-dystopian, anti-capitalist piece that looks practically at creating a sustainable future, optimistically imagining a world where we have overcome climate change. It's not about ignoring the problem but instead thinking about solutions and ways that we can coexist with the planet and each other, encouraging hope in this age of climate anxiety. Despite this serious tone, The Garden is a playful space, allowing people to experiment, be curious and learn through doing, whilst also being a meditative, audio-visual experience. So.... immerse yourself in and connect with this place of optimism.

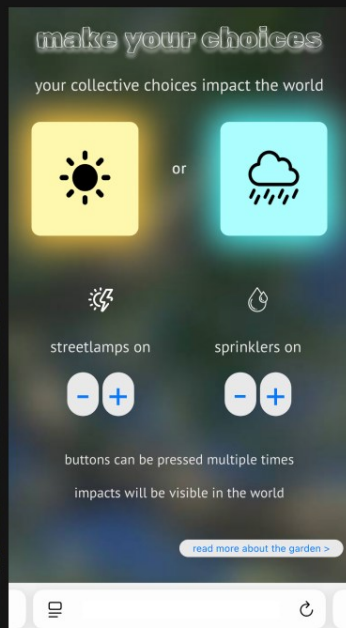
Lead Artist/Creator: Mary Tallontire

Soundscape: Jamie Finlay

Creative Producers: Jemma Baines,

Rachel Down, Darren Adams

more at marytallontire.co.uk/thegarden



we weather the storms

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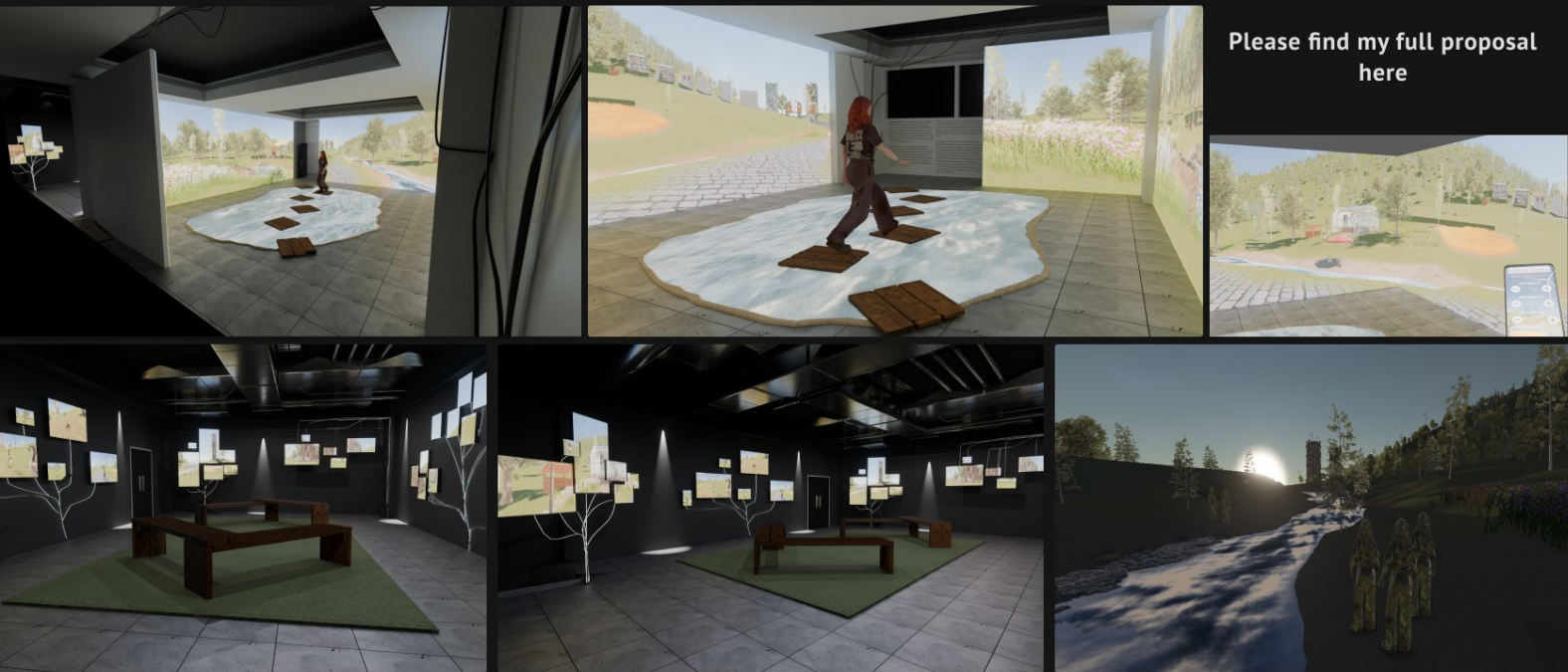
Exhibition proposal created for arebyte Digital Art Centre's artist development programme Hotel Generation 2026. I created this proposal for the arebyte gallery space, with the help of my mentor Sam Mercer (Curator of Digital at The Photographers' Gallery) in May-June 2026. My proposed exhibition, *we weather the storms*, functions as a multiplayer game experience with audiences connecting to a singular, living virtual world visible through multiple screens and immersive projections on their phones. Collectively, audiences react and respond to an unpredictable, dramatic weather system within a virtual ecosystem inspired by solarpunk aesthetics, with each player having agency as an individual but requiring the collective to make major impacts. Anchored in optimism and hope in an era of climate anxiety, the virtual world is a counter-dystopia.

Whilst *we weather the storms* takes inspiration from solarpunk aesthetics, it acknowledges that we have the means of living in a sustainable 'utopian' future now, though this is withheld from the majority due to capital constraints. Leaving behind aspects of science fiction, instead the exhibition intends to highlight the capitalist, colonial systems that need dismantling for us to achieve a sustainable future, looking at how we can reframe our technology to now push us towards a solarpunk world. Rooted in the notion that there can be no separation between technology and ecology, the exhibition examines a

false sense of immateriality in networking and gaming. It strives for a technological landscape that does not depend on profit-driven technologies that largely end up as e-waste, which in the UK is then rapidly exported to the global south.

The multiplayer controls to engage with the digital ecosystem are accessed through audience members' phones, reclaiming mobile phones as a technology of connection and communication instead of the tools of corporate control fostering dopamine dependence, AI slop and algorithms of surveillance. The exhibition purposefully uses pre-existing technologies that aren't cutting edge, reuses digital tools and algorithms, and is largely open-source. The exhibition promotes sustainable innovation with technologies that already exist, without falling into a techno-solutionist mindset, acknowledging that not all problems need to be solved with tech. In an era of culture wars and division, the exhibition aims to unite audiences through play, using game mechanics to allow audiences to experience and experiment with an alternative system of collective resource management, inspiring eco hope and utilising play as a tool of resistance. It looks to foster connection between the physical bodies that exist in the present between the digital projections and screens, generating a sense of community amongst players, whilst also providing a hopeful, reflective, meditative space away from corporatised mindfulness.

Please find my full proposal
here





Breadleg

Digital Game

Comedy

Unity

Blender

Breadleg is an absurdist, comedy game about running round a Scottish village as a piece of bread with legs. Encounter the people of the village and collect socks to help you escape without being eaten, whilst maybe getting involved in a bit of mischief along the way. Discover the world, chat with local wildlife and collect some socks on the way - just make sure you don't get eaten!



Gameplay is approximately 15 minutes long.
Solo project. Released on itch.io on 17th May 2025

more at marytallontire.co.uk/breadleg
I would be happy to provide a free download upon request

Game Developer: Mary Tallontire
Music: Raven1024
Dialogue system: Yarn Spinner



Nowhere Actually Existing

Interactive Digital Art

Immersive Experience

Virtual World

Unity

Blender

Digital worlding piece I created as my final project at Goldsmiths University, developed in Unity. It has existed in multiple forms: a downloadable game, an immersive, meditative space which ran at Goldsmiths in May 2023 and an interactive film at Thin Air, Beams in June 2023. This is Nowhere Actually Existing, and at its core, it is exactly that. It is a digital worldbuilding piece illustrating a place that doesn't exist, and won't ever exist. It is a world that solely comes from my head and my imagination, embodying ideas of simulation being a presentation of a person's perception of reality, originally coming from game designer Doris C. Rusch. Furthermore, it depicts an idyllic, sustainable community, with animals running around freely and wildly, depicting a Utopia, and in particular, my utopia, as it is supposedly perception of reality. The name in particular comes from the book *The Village Against The World* which discusses the village and inhabitants of Marinaleda in Spain who created a 'Utopia' and a foundation for a cooperative way of life. However, this world is only a simulation. However perfect it may present as, it has its flaws and it calls on you to find them. This utopia isn't real, and will assure you you're aware of it.

This piece ran live at Goldsmiths University's SIML space and then at Thin Air, The Beams, both in London. The Goldsmith's version removed the interactivity from the piece, whilst at Beams a limited amount of interaction was added back in to create an interactive film by providing some audience members with an Xbox controller to change the scenery across the screens. Both versions included sound from VenAur, which was created with Pure Data.

more at marytallontire.co.uk/nowhere



Indie Games

Interactive Storytelling

Digital Game

Collaboration

Unity

Blender

I have developed a range of interactive, digital games including autobiographical games about my mental health, educational experiences about urban rewilding and solar punk as well as digital worlds aiming to highlight the power embedded in modern technologies and confront digital oligarchy. These are:

Rarity (2023)

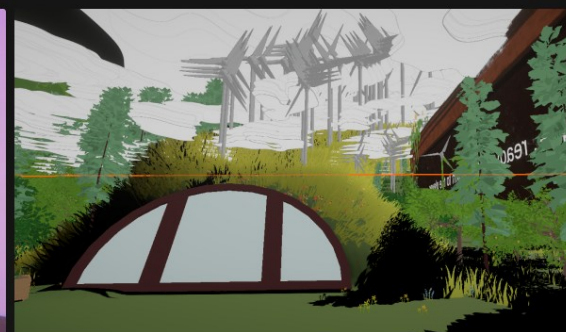
Hedgeborough (2025)

Auntie Jam's Birthday Cake (2025) (Made as part of duo Gertrude Bungalow)

Consumption Model (2025)

Veg Slop (2025)

All can be found on my itch.io account [@matallon](#), with more details on each also available on my website at [marytallontire.co.uk/gallery](#)



Unfolding

[Digital Art](#)[Zines](#)[Video Art](#)[Unity](#)[Blender](#)

I've become engrossed with digital game worlds and the realms within these players are traditionally not supposed to see; spaces that are typically only seen during game development or due to glitches or game breakdown. This collection of screenshots and videos demonstrates some of my explorations around this concept, and the results of spontaneity within the game development process, resulting in imperfect stills with Unity gizmos and UI often still visible.

The worlds featured in the collections are from a variety of my projects such as The Garden, worlds I have built for projection at live music gigs and my currently unfinished artgame Island. This is an ongoing collection, and I compile them in within zines and across my various social media accounts.

My zine 'This wasn't where you were meant to go' containing a collection of these screenshots was featured in the exhibition Connection Established: Digital Folklore and Web Craft at The Photographers' Gallery.

My video artworks 'Lights are on,' 'Places to be,' and 'Stuck in a building and glitched in the floor' were screened at Arebyte's BYOB event on 28th March 2026.

[more at marytallontire.co.uk/unfolding](http://marytallontire.co.uk/unfolding)

